

In a rising market, everyone makes money and a value philosophy may be unnecessary. But because there is no sure way to predict what the market will do, one needs to follow a value philosophy at all times. Value investors must remain hungry and agile, developing new areas of edge to replace those that are arbitrated away as more investors pile in. They must remain humble, intellectually honest, and deeply curious. They must be responsible stewards of capital, taking into account the influence of their companies on their customers, their communities, and the planet. And they must constantly hone their investment process and develop new insights into human behavior, including their own, while learning from mistakes and successes alike. Finally, they must fight the belief that the way things are today is the way they'll always be; history promises us otherwise. By controlling risk and limiting loss through extensive fundamental analysis, strict discipline, and endless patience, however, value investors can expect good results with limited downside.

The real secret to investing is that there is no secret to investing. Every important aspect of value investing has been made available to the public many times over, beginning in 1934 with the first edition of *Security Analysis*. That so many people fail to follow this timeless approach enables those who adopt it to be successful. I know of no long-time investor who regrets adhering to a value philosophy, and few will ever abandon this time-tested approach for another. Human nature guarantees that the hope for and pursuit of rapid and effortless gain will be with us forever. So as long as others succumb to the siren song of getting rich fast, value investing will remain, as it has been for some 90 years, a sound, low-risk, and successful approach. Truly, the concept of buying securities for less than they're worth never grows old. You may not get rich quickly, but you will keep what you have, and if the future of value investing resembles its past, you are likely to get rich slowly. As strategies go, this is the most that any reasonable investor can hope for.